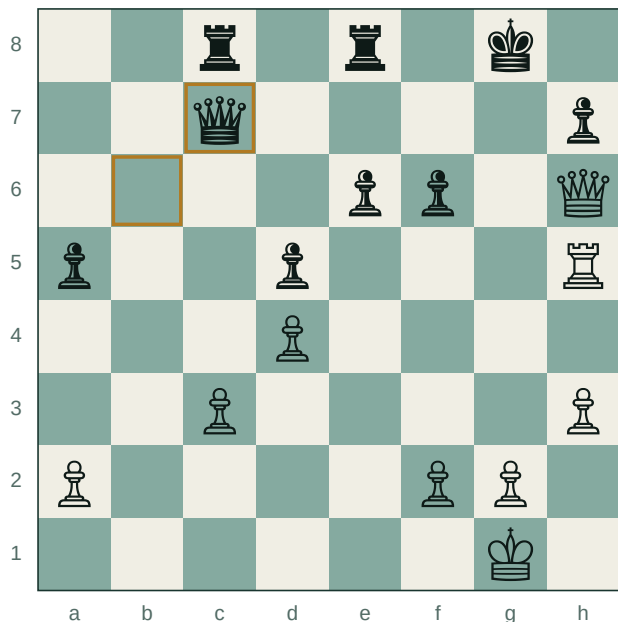


Pins and pressure: White, move 28

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 27...Qc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Qxf6 Qg7 29. Rg5 Qxg5 30. Qxg5+

28.Qxf6 The queen captures the pawn on f6. Recorded reply: **28...Qg7**.

29.Rg5 The rook moves from h5 to g5. Recorded reply: **29...Qxg5**.

30.Qxg5+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.